

(Vo8) Start-Up Enterprise Team

Description & Eligibility

Develop an operating plan and organizational structure to initiate a small business. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Awards will be presented at the National Leadership Conference. Any middle level, secondary or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. **Teams who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines will be disqualified.**

Competition Notes

- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register teams for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>.
 - Click on the “Conferences” tab and then select the “2026 National Virtual Events”.
 - There will be a \$20 fee for each team entry (*invoiced during event registration*).
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after the team registration.
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2025.
 - Teams participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible.
 - Only the team captain should complete the submission.
- Teams are to assume they are presenting their products/services to potential buyers. The event may be repeated but previously used business plans may *not* be submitted.

Technical Pre-submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	Deadline
Business Plan, Works Cited, and BPA Release Form(s) in one combined PDF file.	Vo8-TeamID.pdf	January 15, 2026, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

- Demonstrate knowledge and understanding of entrepreneurship
- Communicate research in a clear and concise manner both orally and in writing
- Demonstrate effective persuasive and informative communication and presentation skills
- Identify and utilize internal and external resources
- Develop a written business plan for a start-up business
- Identify customer base including consumer and organizational markets and demographics
- Identify customer relations or markets
- Demonstrate successful price selection including the reasoning and methods used in determining the price
- Analyze the necessary financial data required to establish their business

Contest Specifications for this Event

- The Business Plan must reflect a new business for team’s community or local area, *not* an expansion of a current business, subsidiary business, or franchise. If a contestant repeats this event, he/she may *not* submit any previously used business plan.
- Information in the Business Plan must be authentic; however, the team may choose to use a fictitious address and telephone number.
- Entries outlining the purchase of a franchise do *not* satisfy the topic and are subject to *disqualification*.
- The Business Plan, including the Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited must be formatted according to the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- The Business Plan must not exceed ten (10) pages single-sided and must follow the Business Plan format (Sections I-VIII) in the *Style & Reference Manual*. All other documentation is not considered to be part of the ten (10) single-sided pages. The Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited are not included in the ten (10) page limit.

- Submit all project documents including the Business Plan, Works Cited, and BPA Release Form(s) in a combined PDF file to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on January 15, 2026.
- An auto-generated confirmation will be provided upon project submission for the National Leadership Conference; individual confirmation cannot be provided. **No changes can be made to the project after the date of submission.**
- Advisors of qualifying teams will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Teams will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- Teams with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered contestants and/or those missing Contestant ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

This event is sponsored by:



(Vo8) Start-up Enterprise Team

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ Y ☐ N
Business Plan did <i>not</i> exceed ten (10) pages single-sided. The Title Page, Table of Contents, and Works Cited are not included in the ten (10) page limit.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to any question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing one (1) Business Plan, Works Cited (formatted according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i>) and BPA Release Form(s).				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-20 points	Above Expectations 21-30 points	Points Awarded
Executive Summary	Lacks detail, unclear, fails to engage.	Provides a clear overview but lacks engagement.	Compelling, detailed, thoroughly engages.	/30
Description of Proposed Business	Vague, lacks clarity, fails to intrigue.	Adequate description that generates interest.	Thorough, intriguing, captivates interest.	/30
Objectives of Business	Unclear or missing Mission and Vision.	Clear Mission and Vision with adequate objectives.	Clear, inspiring Mission and Vision.	/30
Proposed Business Strategies	Vague, unrealistic strategies.	Realistic short-term and long-range plans.	Well-structured, innovative, achievable.	/30
Product(s) and/or Service(s)	Unclear, lacks detail, fails to differentiate.	Adequate description with some unique aspects.	Detailed, compelling, highlights advantages.	/30
Management and Ownership of the Business	Unclear, incomplete organizational chart and roles.	Clear organizational chart with adequately described roles.	Comprehensive organizational chart with detailed roles.	/30
Marketing Analysis	Poorly defined target market, unclear edge.	Clearly defines target market and competitive edge.	In-depth analysis, strong edge, justified pricing.	/30
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-13 points	Meets Expectations 14-27 points	Above Expectations 28-40 points	Points Awarded
Financial Analysis	Incomplete, unrealistic financial information.	Provides adequate financial details, including a basic balance sheet.	Comprehensive, realistic, detailed balance sheet.	/40
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Overall Appearance, Conciseness, and Completeness	Plan is disorganized, wordy, or missing sections.	Plan is well-organized, concise, and complete.	Plan is exceptionally well-organized, concise, and complete.	/20
Writing Accuracy	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/300

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-5 points	Meets Expectations 6-10 points	Above Expectations 11-15 points	Points Awarded
Delivery & Engagement	Team rarely maintains eye contact, uses minimal gestures and body language, or has significant inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team occasionally breaks eye contact, uses limited gestures and body language, or has some inconsistencies in tone and pace.	Team maintains good eye contact, uses appropriate gestures and body language, and varies their tone and pace adequately.	/15
Organization, Design & Structure	Presentation lacks coherence and structure, making it unclear and difficult to follow. Transitions between points are awkward or absent.	Presentation content has some gaps, making it not always clear and somewhat difficult to follow. Transitions between points are choppy.	Presentation content flows adequately, with a mostly clear structure and smooth transitions between points.	/15
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-10 points	Meets Expectations 11-30 points	Above Expectations 31-50 points	Points Awarded
Content Knowledge	Presentation demonstrates a limited understanding of the topic and includes mostly irrelevant or inaccurate information.	Presentation demonstrates a basic understanding of the topic and includes a mix of relevant and irrelevant information.	Presentation demonstrates a good understanding of the topic and includes relevant and accurate information.	/50
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-4 points	Meets Expectations 5-7 points	Above Expectations 8-10 points	Points Awarded
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/10
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Set-up lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/105

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES